

Tableau Lab 01

Sales Performance Dashboard – Sample Superstore

TURN DATA
INTO INSIGHTS

PRACTICE • ANALYZE • BUILD • IMPROVE



Scenario

You are a BI Analyst for Superstore. The Sales Manager needs a one-page dashboard that explains overall performance, where sales are coming from, and where profit problems exist. Build the dashboard so a manager can explore the data without opening individual worksheets.



Learning Goals

- Use Tableau dimensions, measures, dates, geographic fields, and the Marks card correctly.
- Choose visualizations based on a business question instead of creating charts only for practice.
- Use sorting, formatting, tooltips, and filters to make the analysis easier to understand.
- Combine multiple worksheets into one clean, interactive dashboard.



Data Source

Use **Sample – Superstore**. Work mainly with the **Orders** data and the standard fields already available in the dataset.

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Part 1 – Build the Core Analysis

View	Business requirement
KPI Cards	Create four KPI sheets for Total Sales , Total Profit , Total Quantity , and Distinct Orders (COUNTD of Order ID). Format values so they are easy to scan.
Monthly Trend	Show Sales over time using Order Date . Use a continuous monthly timeline and make the trend readable across years.
Sub-Category Profitability	Compare Profit by Sub-Category . Sort the view and make loss-making sub-categories immediately visible.
Geographic View	Create a map that shows Sales by State . The tooltip must also show Profit and Quantity .
Segment Performance	Compare the customer Segments and show both commercial size and profitability in a clear way.

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Part 2 – Filters and Usability



- Add filters for **Region**, **Segment**, and **Order Year**.
- Apply each filter to every worksheet where it is logically relevant.
- Edit tooltips: remove unnecessary field names and write short, readable labels.
- Use useful titles. A title such as “Profit by Sub-Category” is better than ‘Sheet 4’.

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Part 3 – Build One Dashboard



- Create one **desktop dashboard** (recommended size around 1200 x 800).
- Place the **KPI cards** at the top, then arrange the analytical views underneath using containers.
- Show the **Region, Segment, and Year** controls in a compact area.
- Make sure the dashboard still **makes sense** after changing the filters.
- Use **consistent number formatting**, spacing, font sizes, and visual hierarchy.

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Part 4 – Answer the Business Questions



After finishing the dashboard, use it to answer the following questions. Write short answers in your submission or in a small dashboard text object.

1. Which **Region** generates the highest Sales? Is it also the most profitable Region?
2. Which **Sub-Category** creates the largest loss?
3. Which **State** has strong Sales but weak or negative Profit?
4. Which **Segment** contributes the most Sales?
5. What is the clearest pattern you notice in the monthly **Sales trend**?

Design Rules



- Do not add a chart only because Tableau can create it. **Every view must answer a business question.**
- Avoid unnecessary pie/donut charts, 3D effects, excessive labels, and decorative objects.
- Use a limited and consistent visual style. Reserve strong emphasis for important values such as negative Profit.
- Keep enough **white space** so the dashboard does not feel crowded.



Submission Checklist

- **Submit:** (1) the Tableau workbook (.twb or .twbx), (2) one exported dashboard image/PDF, and (3) your five short business answers.
- **Before submitting:** verify that filters work, worksheet names are clear, tooltips are readable, and no object overlaps another.



Optional Bonus

Add a dashboard **Filter Action** so clicking one visual (for example a State or Segment) filters at least one other visual. Keep the dashboard easy to reset.